

# The work, counted twice.

On your own vs. with Candelo running it · a plain, side-by-side inventory of the operating load · June 24, 2026

ON YOUR OWN

~22–35 hr/wk + the four risks, on one person

WITH CANDELO

~2–4 hr/wk of owner-only decisions; risks tracked

## What it takes to run this — on your own, and with Candelo running it

This is a flat, factual inventory of the operating work behind a production-backed storefront. Left column: what you personally have to do, track, and carry if you run the back office yourself. Right column: what the same workstream looks like with Candelo’s Control Room and operating partner handling it. No claims, no pitch — the rows are the rows. Read across each one and decide for yourself.

**How to read it.** Hours are **conservative weekly estimates of the recurring load once the store is open** (a separate one-time setup load is noted where it’s large). "Risk carried" is the operational exposure that sits on whoever owns the row. The right column is honest about what **stays yours no matter what** — signatures, logins, payment authorization, and being the FDA Responsible Person never move; a partner can prepare the decision but can’t make it for you. Where Candelo does little **by design** (the regulated rails), the row says so.

### Permits & licensing

EIN · CDTFA seller's permit · DBA · city business license · county market permit · FDA/MoCRA · food handler cards

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                                                                                                                   | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Research each agency's process, fill 7+ separate forms, file them in the right order, track which is filed / pending / approved, chase responses, then remember every renewal date afterward. | Each form pre-filled to a one-click <b>sign / pay / submit</b> ; each tracked as a status row on the readiness board; renewals surfaced before they lapse. <b>You still sign, pay, and fax</b> — those are yours. |
| ~40–60 hrs <b>one-time</b> across the open window, then ~0.5 hr/wk chasing renewals.                                                                                                          | ~0 hrs of your time beyond the signatures themselves.                                                                                                                                                             |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> a missed filing or a lapsed permit stops sales or triggers fines.                                                                                                  | <i>Risk:</i> a tracked board with renewal flags — a lapse has to get past a system, not just a busy memory.                                                                                                       |

### Inventory · COGS · batch/lot tracking

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                                                                                                            | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Build recipes/BOM, log every batch, assign lot IDs, compute weighted-average COGS by hand, and keep inventory-by-location current — <b>or</b> rent Craftybase at ~\$1,188/yr to do it. | The Control Room self-builds recipes, batches, lot traceability, and weighted COGS, with an append-only Material Ledger; released units transfer to the Shopify sellable location automatically. <b>You approve recipes.</b> Built in at <b>\$0</b> . |

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                                  | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ~4–6 hr/wk, plus the Craftybase fee or the spreadsheet-error risk.                                           | ~0 hr/wk.                                                                                                   |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> wrong COGS → mispriced products; a broken lot trail → you can't isolate a recall. | <i>Risk:</i> current-lot traceability + costed batches that are regulator/insurer-defensible at this scale. |

## Cold-chain temperature logging

frozen grass-fed beef · raw dairy · eggs

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                     | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Log freezer temps on a schedule, hold the records, and personally notice any excursion.         | A temp-logging + receiving workflow holds the defensible record; excursions flag. <b>You (or a sensor) take the reading.</b> |
| ~2–3 hr/wk plus the discipline to never miss a day.                                             | ~0 hr/wk beyond the reading itself.                                                                                          |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> an unlogged excursion = unsellable food and health/insurer exposure. | <i>Risk:</i> a continuous, time-stamped record instead of a memory of "I think I checked."                                   |

## Recall · complaints · adverse events

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                                                                                                                                   | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Take every complaint, judge whether it's serious, know the <b>15-business-day FDA serious-AE clock</b> , trace the lot, hold the batch, and keep the comms — under pressure, on an event you didn't schedule. | Every complaint/AE logged (order ID, batch/lot, category), monitored daily, <b>escalated to you same-day</b> on any serious category; the lot is traced and the batch held; the record is kept. <b>You remain the Responsible Person</b> and own the FDA reporting decision — Candelo makes it a one-decision call <b>inside</b> the window. |
| ~1–2 hr/wk baseline; spikes hard on an actual event.                                                                                                                                                          | ~0–1 hr/wk — you decide on flagged events; the legwork is done.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> this is the <b>highest-consequence row</b> — a missed serious-AE window or an untraceable lot.                                                                                     | <i>Risk:</i> the window and the lot trail are both system-held; the decision still reaches you in time.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

## Daily closeout

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                                    | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reconcile the day's totals against POS, check cash over/short, and note exceptions — <b>every single day</b> . | Aggregated totals taken into the closeout; cash over/short auto-computed; mismatches flagged. <b>You read the flagged exceptions.</b> (Copied totals only — no card or bank data ever enters the system.) |
| ~3–5 hr/wk.                                                                                                    | ~0–0.5 hr/wk.                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> drift between POS and reality; cash shrink you don't catch.                         | <i>Risk:</i> a daily reconciled close with exceptions surfaced the same day.                                                                                                                              |

## Reorder · purchasing

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                                                          | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Watch stock, remember reorder points, time freezer restocks with the supplier, and thread the needle between stockouts and spoilage. | Reorder points set; low-stock and below-reorder flags come off the closeouts weekly.<br><b>You place the orders.</b> |
| ~2–3 hr/wk.                                                                                                                          | ~0.5 hr/wk (placing the orders).                                                                                     |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> stockouts (lost sales) or over-ordering perishables (spoilage).                                           | <i>Risk:</i> reorder signals arrive before the shelf is empty.                                                       |

## Weekly reporting

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                                                                           | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                 |
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| Pull sales by channel, margin by family, production output, waste, labor %, and tax liability into something you can actually read — by hand, weekly. | A weekly owner report is generated and sent (Google Doc), ending in <b>what to make / restock / fix / stop. You read it and decide.</b> |
| ~2–3 hr/wk.                                                                                                                                           | ~0.25 hr/wk (reading it).                                                                                                               |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> running on gut instead of numbers.                                                                                         | <i>Risk:</i> decisions teed up against current figures.                                                                                 |

## Owner dashboard

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                     | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Assemble the at-a-glance numbers from scattered tools whenever you want a read. | The dashboard refreshes daily; tiles stay current; the launch-blocker / exception list is live. <b>You glance.</b> |
| ~1–2 hr/wk.                                                                     | ~0 hr/wk.                                                                                                          |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> no current picture between manual pulls.             | <i>Risk:</i> a cockpit that's current without you assembling it.                                                   |

## Vendor & COA compliance

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                                                | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Collect a COA per lot, verify each food vendor's permits + resale certificates, qualify new suppliers, and chase the gaps. | A supplier master runs the CoA-per-lot check, flags gaps, and qualifies new suppliers on an SOP. <b>You sign the vendor agreements.</b> |
| ~1–2 hr/wk.                                                                                                                | ~0.25 hr/wk.                                                                                                                            |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> an unqualified vendor or a missing COA = compliance and recall exposure.                        | <i>Risk:</i> every received lot is checked against a CoA on file.                                                                       |

## Bookkeeping / QBO (the row where Candelo does the least — by design)

| ON YOUR OWN | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|             | Candelo <b>feeds unit COGS</b> into the system and <b>never holds the ledger.</b> QuickBooks Online stays the ledger of record on your accounts — it's a |

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                          | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Categorize transactions, reconcile, and keep the ledger clean — or pay a bookkeeper. | regulated rail Candelo doesn't custom-build or operate. <b>This stays you and your accountant.</b> |
| ~2–4 hr/wk (or the bookkeeper's fee).                                                | ~2–4 hr/wk still yours — Candelo reduces the COGS-side work, not the books themselves.             |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> a messy ledger at tax time.                               | <i>Risk:</i> unchanged on the ledger side — honestly, this rail stays with you.                    |

## Marketing / Google Business Profile

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                                               | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stand up Google Business Profile + Apple Maps, tie store social to the existing online audience, keep hours/info current. | Candelo stands up the Google Business Profile + Apple Maps and ties IG/TikTok to the existing audience. <b>You approve voice and posts; ongoing content stays yours</b> unless scoped in. |
| ~1–2 hr/wk (more at launch).                                                                                              | Setup handled; ~1 hr/wk ongoing stays yours for content.                                                                                                                                  |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> invisible to local search on opening day.                                                      | <i>Risk:</i> discoverable at open; ongoing posting is still your call.                                                                                                                    |

## POS setup

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                 | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Choose the POS, configure registers + market mode, build the catalog, connect the channels. | Candelo configures Square (register + markets) and connects the Control Room sales feed — which is <b>POS-agnostic</b> (reads Square or Shopify). <b>You hold the Square login + payment authorization.</b> |
| ~6–10 hrs one-time + ~0.5 hr/wk upkeep.                                                     | ~0 hrs beyond holding the login.                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> a misconfigured POS at open = checkout chaos.                    | <i>Risk:</i> configured and connected before the doors open.                                                                                                                                                |

## Delivery & cold-chain (in transit)

| ON YOUR OWN                                                                                       | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Plan the delivery/van, keep the cold chain intact in transit, and log it.                         | Delivery cold-chain logging folds into the same temp-log workflow; receiving/transfer is recorded. <b>You (or the driver) make the run;</b> the delivery-van plan is still an open decision of yours. |
| ~1–2 hr/wk.                                                                                       | ~0.5 hr/wk (the run itself).                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <i>Risk carried alone:</i> a broken cold chain in transit = spoiled/unsafe product and liability. | <i>Risk:</i> a logged chain of custody from freezer to customer.                                                                                                                                      |

TOTALS — what each column actually costs you

|                                                               | ON YOUR OWN                                      | WITH CANDELO RUNNING IT                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Recurring back-office load, once open                         | ~22–35 hr/wk<br><i>(conservative)</i>            | ~2–4 hr/wk — signatures, logins, payment auth, gating decisions, Responsible-Person calls |
| One-time setup load (across the open)                         | ~50–75 hrs of filing, configuring, building      | ~hours — mostly your signatures; the rest is built/pre-filled                             |
| Tooling cost                                                  | ~\$1,188/yr Craftybase (or hand-built COGS risk) | \$0 for the production/COGS layer (self-built)                                            |
| Compliance risk <i>(lapsed permit/claim)</i>                  | Held in one busy owner's memory                  | Tracked board + renewal flags                                                             |
| Recall risk <i>(untraceable lot / missed 15-day AE clock)</i> | Carried alone, under event pressure              | System-held lot trail + same-day escalation; <b>you still decide</b>                      |
| Cash risk <i>(undetected over/short, shrink)</i>              | Caught only if you reconcile that day            | Daily reconciled close, exceptions flagged                                                |
| Stockout risk <i>(lost sales / spoiled perishables)</i>       | Watched by hand                                  | Reorder-point flags before the shelf empties                                              |

The one-line read: roughly a **half-time-job's worth of recurring operating work** — plus the four named risks — sits on one person if the back office is run solo. With Candelo running it, the recurring work drops to **a few hours a week of owner-only decisions**, and the risks move from *remembered* to *tracked*. What stays yours is exactly what should: the signatures, the money authorizations, the logins, and the legal Responsible-Person calls. **The regulated rails — payments, payroll, the ledger, banking, insurance, tax filing, security — never move; they stay on your accounts with proven vendors. Candelo operates the overlay, not the rails.**

The imbalance in these rows isn't an argument. It's just the work, counted twice.

*Reusable as the Candelo AI Operations Partner value-demonstration template — swap the workstreams and the hour estimates per client; keep the two-column, count-it-twice structure. Estimates are conservative and client-specific; confirm against each business's real volume. Not legal or tax advice — worker classification and entity/tax elections are fact-specific; confirm with a California employment attorney and a CPA.*